Practicum 1: Replicating Bartels (2000)

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##Introduction This write-up copies Figures 1 and 2 from Bartels (2000). I used the CCES survey for the years 2006 to 2024.

Figure 1

Figure 1 shows how many people are in each of four groups: strong, weak, leaners and pure independents. Strong is the biggest group, at about 0.4. Weak is about 0.2 to 0.3. Leaners are about 0.2, and pure independents are about 0.1 to 0.2. The lines stay about the same from 2006 to 2024. This means people's party loyalty did not change much.

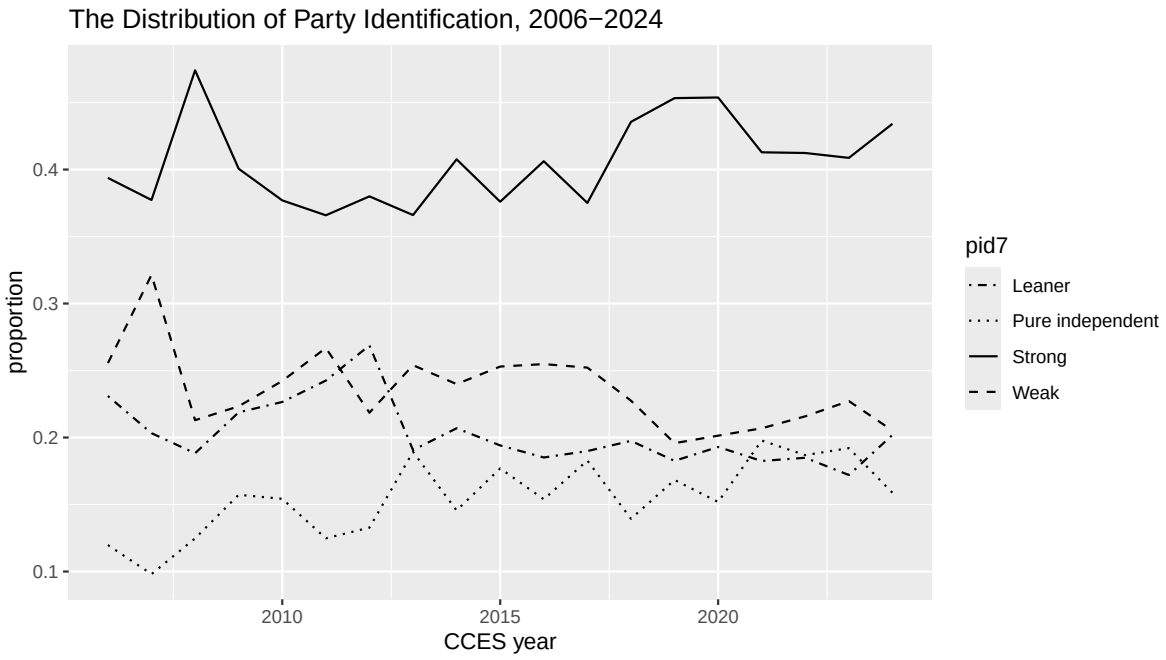
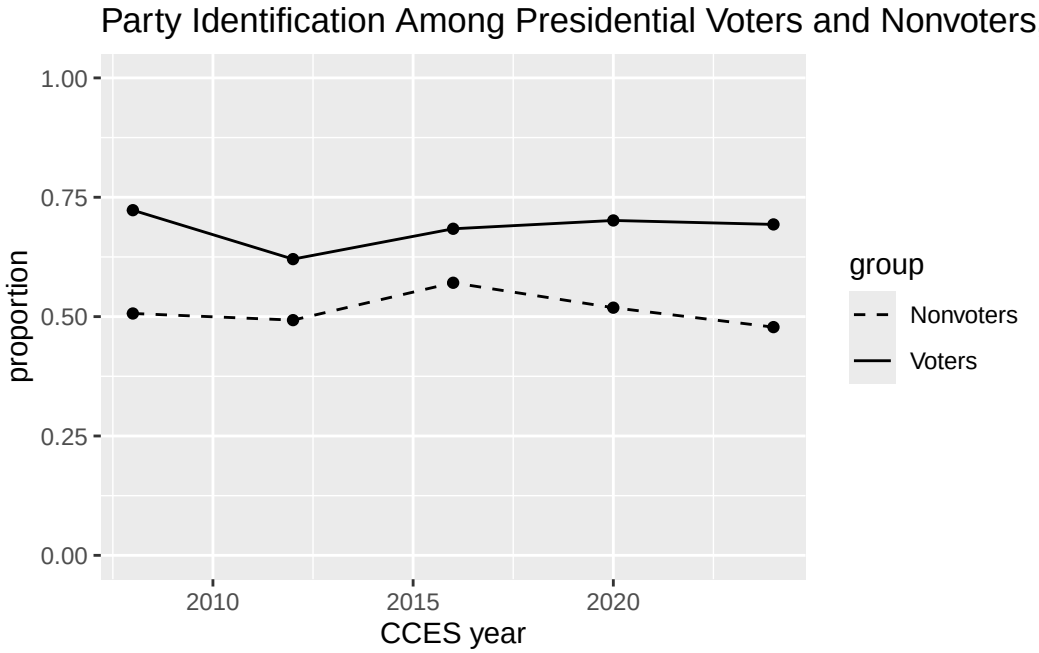


Figure 1: The Distribution of Party Identification, 2006-2024

Figure 2

Figure 2 shows how many voters and nonvoters are strong or weak party identifiers. It uses presidential election years only: 2008, 2012, 2016, 2020 and 2024. Voters are always higher than nonvoters. Voters are at about 0.6 to 0.7, and nonvoters are at about 0.5. This means people who vote are more loyal to a party than people who do not vote.



Challenges

The party answers in the data were numbers, so my code did not work until I changed them into words with as_factor(). Some people answered "Not Sure" or gave no answer, so I removed them. The survey was a different size each year, so I used proportions and the survey weights to compare the years fairly.

Differences from Bartels

Bartels used the ANES survey for 1952 to 1996. I used the online CCES survey for 2006 to 2024. In Bartels' Figure 1, weak identifiers (people who pick a party, but not strongly) are about the same as or higher than strong ones. In mine, strong identifiers are higher, at about 0.4, and weak ones are lower, at about 0.2 to 0.3. In both Figure 2s, voters are more loyal to a party than nonvoters, but my numbers are a little lower. The difference may come from the different survey and years.